

RestaurantOS

Hotel & Restaurant Management Platform

User Manual

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Table of Contents

Table of Contents	2
1. About RestaurantOS	3
2. Getting Started	3
3. User Roles	3
4. Restaurant & Branch Management	4
5. Table Management	5
6. QR Codes	5
7. Menu Management	6
8. Taking Orders	6
9. Kitchen & Bar Workflow	6
10. KDS / Queue	6
11. Billing	7
12. Payments	7
13. Table Closing	8
14. End-of-Day Reporting	8
15. Inventory	8
16. RBAC & Security	9
17. Common Daily Operating Procedure	9
18. Troubleshooting	10
19. Important Business Rules -- Quick Reference	10
20. Quick Reference Cards	11
21. Known Limitations	11

1. About RestaurantOS

RestaurantOS is a back-office and point-of-sale system for a single restaurant, bar, or hotel food & beverage operation. It covers the full flow from a guest placing an order through to the bill being paid and the day being reconciled.

Who uses it: the restaurant/branch manager, waiters, bartenders, kitchen staff, and an inventory manager, each with a different login and a different set of screens and actions available to them.

Main workflow

```
Customer
-> QR order (guest) OR Waiter order (staff)
-> Kitchen ticket / Bar ticket
-> Preparation (Fired -> In Progress -> Ready -> Served)
-> Bill generated
-> Payment (partial and/or final)
-> Table automatically becomes Available
-> End-of-Day Reporting
```

Every step above exists in the current system and has been verified against a real, running deployment.

2. Getting Started

Login

Staff log in with an email and password. There is no self-service sign-up for staff accounts.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER -- Login page: email field, password field, Log In button]

Dashboard

After login, staff land on a dashboard showing an operational summary for their branch.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER -- Dashboard: operational summary cards, branch selector, sidebar navigation]

Navigation, Branch Selection, and Permissions

The sidebar lists only the sections the logged-in user's role can access. Most screens are scoped to one branch. What a user can see and do is enforced by the server, not just the interface.

3. User Roles

Every action is gated by a real, server-enforced permission check. Two additional roles (Cashier, Accountant) exist but are not covered here in daily detail.

Owner / Admin (Tenant Owner)

Can see	Everything -- every branch, every screen.
Can do	Everything, including granting/revoking other users' roles.
Cannot do	Nothing is withheld.
Daily role	Overall business setup and oversight.

Manager (Restaurant Manager / Branch Manager)

Can see	Branch details, tables, menu, reservations, orders, kitchen tickets, billing, inventory, purchasing, reports.
Can do	Manage tables, reservations, orders, kitchen tickets, bills/payment, inventory, purchasing. Restaurant Manager only.
Cannot do	Grant/revoke staff roles (Tenant Owner only).
Daily role	Oversee the floor, resolve billing/table issues, review the end-of-day report.

Waiter

Can see	Tables, menu, reservations, orders.
Can do	Read tables/menu, manage reservations, create and manage orders.
Cannot do	Generate/view bills, take payment, touch inventory/purchasing.
Daily role	Seat guests, take orders, fire to kitchen, hand off to billing.

Bartender

Can see	Menu, kitchen/bar tickets.
Can do	Read menu, read/update kitchen tickets (no separate bar-only queue exists; filtered by station).
Cannot do	Create orders, manage tables, billing/inventory.
Daily role	Work the bar-station ticket queue.

Kitchen Staff

Can see	Menu, kitchen/bar tickets.
Can do	Read menu (incl. availability), read/update kitchen tickets.
Cannot do	Create orders, manage tables, billing/inventory.
Daily role	Work the kitchen-station ticket queue.

Inventory Manager

Can see	Inventory categories/items, recipes, suppliers, purchase orders.
Can do	Manage stock, define/revise recipes, manage suppliers/purchase orders.
Cannot do	Take orders, access POS/kitchen or billing.
Daily role	Keep stock current, record deliveries, maintain recipes.

Why permissions matter: if a screen or button seems to be missing, the most likely explanation is that the role genuinely lacks that permission -- this is enforced by the server, not a bug. See Section 16 and 18.

4. Restaurant & Branch Management

- **Restaurant:** the top-level business entity. Can have one or more branches.
- **Branch:** one physical location. Tables, menu, orders, billing, and inventory are all scoped to a branch.
- **Branch status:** active/inactive; an inactive branch is not available for day-to-day operations.

- **Operating hours:** configurable per branch, per day of week.
- **Branch management:** editing branch details is available to Restaurant Manager and Tenant Owner.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER -- Branch details page: name, address, operating hours, status]

5. Table Management

Table zones and statuses

Tables are organized into zones (e.g., Indoor, Outdoor, Rooftop), each with numbered tables. A table's status is Available, Occupied, or an administrative status (e.g., for cleaning) used only when genuinely needed.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER -- Table zones/floor plan, each table showing its current status]

Verified table lifecycle

Available

- > order created on the table -> Occupied
- > partial payment made -> still Occupied
- > bill fully settled -> automatically Available

The table release on full payment is automatic. Staff should not manually change a table's status back to Available after a normal, successful final payment.

Table reuse

Once a table is back to Available, a new order can be created on it immediately -- verified working correctly, including reuse on the same table within one day.

Important -- multiple orders on one table

The system does not currently prevent a second, separate order from being created on a table that already has one open. This does not cause billing errors, but the two orders bill independently -- a guest could unintentionally get two bills for one visit. **Safe operating procedure:** if a table already has an order and the guest wants more of the same visit, add items to the existing order rather than starting a new one. Only start a new order once the table has returned to Available. Talk to your manager before intentionally splitting one table's visit into separate checks.

6. QR Codes

- **What they are:** each table can have a unique QR code linked to it.
- **How guests scan them:** the guest's phone camera opens a link.
- **How it resolves:** the link takes the guest straight to that table's ordering page -- restaurant, branch, and table are already known.
- **Guest menu:** the full live menu for that branch.
- **Guest cart:** add items, adjust quantities, before submitting.
- **Guest order submission:** automatically fired to the kitchen/bar on submit -- no separate manual fire step.

Guest vs. staff functionality: guest pages are deliberately minimal -- menu, cart, and order status only. No visibility into other tables, other orders, or any staff/admin screen.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER -- Guest QR landing: resolved table/branch banner]

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER -- Guest menu: categories and items with prices]

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER -- Guest cart: selected items, quantities, total, Submit Order button]

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER -- Guest order confirmation: item statuses, order total]

7. Menu Management

- **Menu categories:** items are grouped into categories.
- **Menu items:** each has a name and a price.
- **Availability:** an item can be marked unavailable ("86'd") without deleting it.
- **Modifiers:** modifier groups can be attached where configured (size, spice level, add-ons).
- **Branch pricing/availability overrides:** a menu item's price or availability can be overridden per branch.

Menu editing: Restaurant Manager, Tenant Owner, Inventory Manager (recipe-linked). Branch Manager, Waiter, Bartender, Kitchen Staff: read-only.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER -- Menu category list with item counts]

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER -- Menu item detail: name, price, category, availability toggle]

8. Taking Orders

A. Guest QR Order

Guest: Scan QR -> View menu -> Add food/drinks to cart -> Submit order

Fired to the kitchen/bar automatically on submission.

B. Waiter Order

Waiter: Select table -> Add food/drinks -> Review order -> Fire order

A waiter order stays editable until explicitly fired, giving the waiter a chance to confirm with the guest first.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER -- Waiter order entry: table selector, item picker, running order, Fire Order button]

9. Kitchen & Bar Workflow

Order -> Ticket -> Station (Kitchen or Bar)

Items configured to route to the kitchen produce a kitchen ticket; drinks route to the bar. One order with both correctly produces both ticket types.

Fired -> In Progress -> Ready -> Served

Kitchen Staff mark kitchen tickets through these states; Bartenders do the same for bar tickets. Marking Served is also the trigger point for automatic inventory deduction where a recipe exists (Section 15).

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER -- Kitchen Display Screen: ticket cards with status-change controls]

10. KDS / Queue

The Kitchen Display shows every open ticket for the branch, split by station (kitchen vs. bar). Staff should process tickets top to bottom unless a manager directs otherwise.

On FIFO (first-in-first-out) behavior

Tickets have consistently appeared in creation order in real, repeated testing, both branch-wide and within each station. This is a genuinely observed pattern, but the system's own architecture documentation does not make a formal, absolute guarantee of strict ordering under every possible condition (e.g. very high concurrent load). Treat queue order as a reliable guide for normal service, not an unbreakable promise.

11. Billing

- **Subtotal:** sum of item prices (quantity x unit price).
- **Tax:** calculated automatically from the branch's configured tax rate(s).
- **Amount Due:** subtotal + tax, minus adjustments, minus what's already paid.
- **Amount Paid:** running total of payments recorded.
- **Partial payment:** accepted; bill stays open.
- **Full payment:** a payment covering the remaining Amount Due closes the bill.
- **Overpayment protection:** a payment larger than Amount Due is rejected; nothing changes on a rejected attempt.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER -- Bill detail: subtotal, tax, adjustments, amount paid, amount due, payment history]

IMPORTANT BUSINESS RULE -- Tips are not part of the RestaurantOS bill

RestaurantOS v1 does not include a tip field anywhere in billing or payment. The amount owed is exactly food/drink subtotal plus tax. If a guest wants to tip: cash directly to the server, or UPI/direct arrangement between guest and server. **Never enter a tip amount into RestaurantOS -- there is no field for it, and it should not be recorded in the system at all.**

12. Payments

Amount to pay defaults to the bill's current Amount Due; staff enter the amount actually tendered (never more than Amount Due).

Final payment recorded
-> Bill closes
-> Order closes
-> Table automatically becomes Available

No separate close-bill, close-order, or release-table action is needed after a normal final payment.

No refund workflow

RestaurantOS v1 has no refund workflow -- there is no refund button anywhere, deliberately. A genuine refund situation must be handled entirely outside RestaurantOS (cash directly, or your card/UPI provider's own dispute process).

Payment failures: RestaurantOS records that a payment of a given amount/tender type was taken; it does not itself process card/UPI transactions. Your actual payment terminal/provider remains the system of record for

whether the underlying transaction succeeded.

13. Table Closing

Normal case: do nothing extra -- the table becomes Available automatically on final payment (Section 12).

Do not manually release a table after a successful payment

Manual table-status changes should be reserved for genuine administrative situations the automatic flow doesn't cover (cleaning, maintenance, or the multi-order workaround in Section 5). If a table doesn't release itself after a normal payment, treat that as a red flag -- check with your manager immediately rather than assuming a manual release is the correct fix (see Section 18).

14. End-of-Day Reporting

- Order count and voided order count
- Items sold count
- Gross sales amount and voided sales amount
- Total collected amount (across every tender type)
- Total tips amount
- Total refunded amount
- Net collected amount
- Tender breakdown (cash/card, amounts and payment counts)
- Top items sold that day

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER -- End-of-day report: summary figures, tender breakdown, top items]

Read the Total Tips and Total Refunded lines correctly

Given the business rules in Sections 11-12, Total Tips Amount and Total Refunded Amount will always read 0. This is correct, expected behavior, not a bug -- it means RestaurantOS does not track tips given directly to staff, not that no one tipped today. Do not misreport this to ownership.

15. Inventory

An Inventory Manager can create categories/items, record stock movements (adjustments, waste, transfers -- each requiring a reason and approving user), and define recipes linking a menu item to its ingredients.

Automatic deduction only works where a recipe is configured

When a menu item has a recipe configured, marking one of its order items Served automatically deducts the recipe's ingredient quantities from stock. If a menu item has NO recipe configured, marking it Served does nothing to stock levels. Do not assume every item is being tracked automatically -- only items an Inventory Manager has explicitly given a recipe. Track other items' stock manually until a recipe is built.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER -- Inventory item detail: stock on hand, reorder point, recent stock movements]

16. RBAC & Security

RBAC = Role-Based Access Control. Every user has one or more roles (Section 3), and every role has a fixed, specific permission list.

- Screens only appear if the role has at least read access.
- Buttons for unauthorized actions are hidden where the interface supports it.
- **Backend authorization is the important part:** permissions are re-checked on the server for every action, verified directly and repeatedly -- an unauthorized attempt returns a clear "permission denied" error, never a silent failure or an accidental success.
- Most roles are granted per branch; access at one branch does not imply access at another.

17. Common Daily Operating Procedure

Manager

- Log in, confirm branch
- Check tables for leftovers from yesterday
- Check menu availability
- Confirm staff logins
- Monitor orders/kitchen/bar/billing
- Run and review End-of-Day report

Waiter

- Seat guest / point to QR code
- Take order or monitor QR order
- Confirm with guest, then Fire
- Track through preparation
- Present bill
- Record payment (or hand to Cashier)
- Confirm table auto-released -- never release manually

Kitchen Staff

- Open Kitchen Display
- Work tickets in queue order
- Fired -> In Progress -> Ready -> Served, no skipping

Bartender

Same as Kitchen Staff, for bar-station tickets.

Inventory Manager

- Review stock levels
- Record deliveries via goods receipt
- Record waste/adjustments with a reason
- Keep recipes current for auto-deduction items
- Never fabricate a "sale deduction" manually

18. Troubleshooting

Symptom	Likely cause	What to do
Cannot log in	Wrong credentials or account not created	Double-check; confirm account exists
No access to a screen	Role lacks that permission	Likely expected -- confirm with manager
Table appears Occupied unexpectedly	Table or order/bill was never fully settled	Check for an open bill on that table first
Order not visible	Wrong branch selected	Confirm branch and table
Ticket not visible in KDS	Order not yet fired, or wrong station queue	Confirm fired status; check both queues
Payment rejected	Likely an overpayment attempt	Re-check exact Amount Due, re-enter
Overpayment error	Entered more than Amount Due -- expected Recharge	Re-enter the exact Amount Due
Table does not release after payment	Should be automatic -- may indicate a real issue	Do not manually release; escalate immediately
QR doesn't resolve	Wrong/expired code for that table	Confirm the current, correct code
Menu item unavailable	Intentionally 86'd, or a branch override	Check with kitchen/management first
Wrong branch showing	Branch selector or account grant	Re-select correct branch; check grant
Server/backend unavailable	Application server down/restarting	Wait briefly, retry; tell a manager if it persists

19. Important Business Rules -- Quick Reference

- Customer pays only the restaurant bill (food/drink subtotal + tax)
- Tips are outside RestaurantOS -- cash or direct UPI to the server, never entered into the system
- No RestaurantOS refund workflow -- handle refunds entirely outside the system
- Partial payment keeps the table Occupied
- Final payment releases the table automatically -- never release it manually as a normal step
- Overpayment is rejected automatically
- Kitchen/bar ticket queue order is reliable in normal use, not a formally guaranteed promise
- Permissions are enforced by the server on every action
- Automatic inventory deduction only happens for menu items with a configured recipe
- More than one order can currently exist on the same table at once -- follow Section 5's safe-operating guidance

20. Quick Reference Cards

MANAGER -- Daily Checklist

- Log in, confirm branch
- Check tables
- Check menu availability
- Confirm staff logins
- Monitor orders/kitchen/bar/billing
- Run End-of-Day report

WAITER -- Order & Payment Checklist

- Seat guest / QR code
- Take or monitor order
- Confirm, then Fire
- Track preparation
- Present bill
- Record payment
- Confirm auto-release

KITCHEN -- KDS Checklist

- Open KDS
- Work queue order
- Fired -> In Progress -> Ready -> Served

BARTENDER -- Bar Checklist

- Same as Kitchen, bar-station tickets

INVENTORY MANAGER -- Inventory Checklist

- Review stock
- Record deliveries
- Record waste/adjustments with reason
- Keep recipes current
- Never fabricate deductions

21. Known Limitations

- **Multiple concurrent orders can exist on one table** -- see Section 5 for the safe-operating workaround. Does not corrupt billing, but can produce two bills for one visit if not handled carefully.

- **Automatic inventory deduction only works for menu items with a configured recipe** -- built and correct where a recipe exists, not automatic otherwise.
- **No formally guaranteed FIFO ordering promise** -- reliably observed, not an absolute architectural guarantee under every condition.
- **No refund workflow** -- deliberately removed in this version.
- **No tip field** -- deliberately excluded from this version.
- **Cash Drawer status is not persisted across a page reload** -- tracked only in the browser session that opened it.

This manual will be updated as these items are addressed in future versions.